

10 > Set up Android like a power user

- Review Google services carefully. Location, backup, scanning, diagnostics and personalisation settings should not be accepted blindly. Choose what you actually want.
- Skip optional promotional app bundles if the phone maker offers them. Many brands include “recommended apps” during setup. Recommended for whom is the question.
- Reach the home screen, but do not start installing everything yet.

The Google account is the anchor

Your Google account is not just an email login. On Android, it is the anchor for Play Store apps, contacts, backup, Find Hub, Gmail, Photos, Drive, Calendar, passwords, passkeys and device security. Use the account you actually control and intend to keep. Do not set up your personal phone using a temporary work account, a relative’s account, or an old account whose password you barely remember.

After setup, go to Settings > Google and confirm the account shown there. Then go to Security inside your Google account and check recovery phone, recovery email and two-step verification. This is boring until the day your phone is lost and your account becomes the only bridge back to your digital life.

If the phone is for a parent, child or shared household member, resist the temptation to use your own account for convenience. Set up their account properly. A phone tied to the wrong person’s account becomes confusing during app installs, backups, YouTube history, location sharing and device recovery.

Secure the device before decorating it

Before wallpapers, icon packs and widgets, secure the phone. Set a PIN that is not your birthday, vehicle number, house number,

0000, 1234 or a pattern visible from across the room. Add fingerprint unlock if available. Add face unlock if you like, but remember that implementation quality varies across phones.

Now enable the phone-finding feature. Google has renamed and expanded its device-location experience as Find Hub, replacing the old Find My Device branding across Android settings and apps. It is designed to help locate Android phones and supported accessories, with device-finding controls available through Android settings and the Find Hub app/web experience.

Also make sure Google Play Protect is active. Google says Play Protect runs safety checks on apps from the Play Store before download, checks the device for potentially harmful apps from other sources, warns users, and may deactivate or remove harmful apps. Google’s developer documentation also describes Play Protect as built-in malware defence that automatically scans apps on Android phones.

Step-by-step: secure the new phone

- Open Settings > Security and privacy.
- Set or confirm your screen lock.
- Add fingerprint unlock.
- Add face unlock only if you are comfortable with the phone’s implementation.
- Open Settings > Google > Find Hub or search Find Hub in Settings. Turn on device location features where available.
- Open the Play Store, tap your profile picture, then Play Protect. Confirm scanning is on.
- Search Unknown app installs in Settings. Make sure no random app has permission to install APKs.
- Open Settings > Notifications and hide sensitive content on the lock screen if you receive banking alerts, OTPs or private messages.

Dual SIM setup: the Indian power move

For Indian users, dual SIM setup is not a small preference. It can affect calls, mobile data, OTPs, roaming, UPI registration, WhatsApp, office calls and family reachability. Google’s Pixel help page describes Android dual-SIM controls such as adding SIMs, choosing mobile data, automatic data switching and temporarily turning off a SIM. Other brands use different menus, but the principle remains the same.

First, name your SIMs. Do not leave them as SIM 1 and SIM 2 if you can rename them to Jio, Airtel, Vi, Work, Personal, Mumbai, Travel or whatever makes sense. Then choose your default SIM for mobile data. Choose your default calling SIM or set the phone to ask every time. Set the SMS SIM carefully, especially if one number is linked to banks and UPI.

If your UPI number is on SIM 2 but SMS defaults to SIM 1, verification may fail or confuse you. If your work number is SIM 2 but calls default to SIM 1, you may accidentally call clients

